AI NOTES SERIES | PICTURES

Colouring Page for Kids

One copy-and-paste prompt that turns any subject - an animal, a fruit, a vehicle, a letter - into a clean black-and-white colouring page you can print at home or in class.



Notes by Shah Fahad

AI and Technology Innovator | Educator - Buner, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

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For: Parents, primary teachers and older students making colouring pages for young children. **Works with:** ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Muse and other AI tools that can make images. **Time:** About 2 minutes from prompt to printable page.

A good colouring page is simple, bold and empty inside

Ask AI for a picture of an elephant and you usually get a shaded, coloured, detailed image. A young child cannot colour that. The picture is already finished - there is nothing left for small hands to do.

A real colouring page is different. It is only outlines: thick black lines, big white spaces, and one clear subject. This shortcut adds exactly those instructions to your prompt, so the AI draws a page a child aged 4 to 8 can actually enjoy - and a teacher or parent can print again and again.

> **Remember:** The four magic words are **thick outlines, large spaces, no shading, no colour**. If any one of them is missing, the page becomes hard to colour. This prompt includes all four, every time.

What this prompt makes AI do

- **Draw in black and white only** - pure line art, with no colour fill and no grey shading.
- **Use thick, bold outlines** - lines a young child can see clearly and stay inside.
- **Leave large open spaces** - big areas inside each shape, made for crayons and thick pencils.
- **Keep one subject per page** - one animal, one fruit or one vehicle, large and in the centre.
- **Add only a simple background** - a sun, a cloud, grass or a tree, never a busy scene.
- **Put no words on the page** - AI often spells letters wrongly, so the page stays picture-only.

Ideas children love

Theme	Example subjects
Animals and birds	Baby elephant, lion, cat, duck, butterfly, fish
Food and nature	Apple, mango, sunflower, tree, house with a garden
Vehicles	Bus, tractor, aeroplane, bicycle, boat
Learning pages	Big letter A with an apple, number 5 with five stars, circle and square

The copy-and-paste prompt

Copy the box below exactly. Replace **[SUBJECT]** with what the child wants to colour, and **[AGE]** with the child's age. Paste it into any AI tool that can create images, download the picture, and print it.

The Master Prompt ChatGPT - Claude - Gemini - Muse

> Create a printable colouring page for a child aged [AGE]. Subject: [SUBJECT]. Draw it in black and white line art only: thick bold black outlines, large open white spaces inside every shape, no colour fill, no shading, no grey. Keep the subject large, friendly and in the centre, with a very simple background (for example a sun, a cloud or grass). Simple shapes only, suitable for young children. No text, no words and no letters anywhere in the image.

Tip: One subject works best. Write "a baby elephant under a tree" instead of "a jungle with many animals". If the first page has thin lines or shading, reply: "Make the outlines thicker and remove all shading" - most tools will fix it in one step.

Three useful variations

1. Learning Page - Letter, Number or Shape

> Create a black-and-white colouring page that teaches [LETTER / NUMBER / SHAPE]. Show it very large in the centre with thick bold outlines and large white spaces, with [OBJECT THAT MATCHES IT] beside it - for example the letter A with an apple. No shading, no colour fill, no other text.

Use when: You want colouring and learning together - a favourite in nursery and Class 1.

2. Story Character Page

> Create a black-and-white colouring page of [CHARACTER OR ANIMAL] from the story of [STORY NAME], doing [ONE SIMPLE ACTION]. Thick bold outlines, large open white spaces, no shading, no colour, no text. Friendly face, simple clothes and background, suitable for a child aged [AGE].

Use when: A child has just heard a story and wants to colour its hero while you retell it.

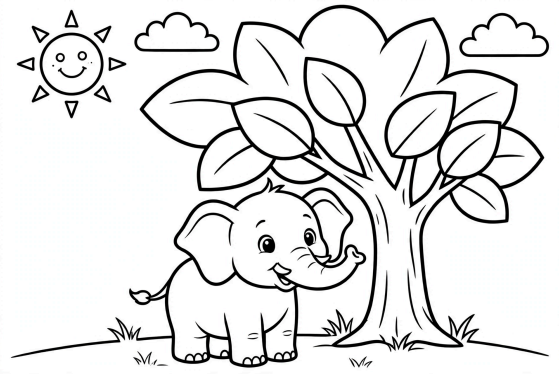
3. Class Set - 5 Pages on One Theme

> Create 5 separate black-and-white colouring pages on the theme of [THEME - for example farm animals], one different subject on each page: [SUBJECT 1], [SUBJECT 2], [SUBJECT 3], [SUBJECT 4] and [SUBJECT 5]. Every page: thick bold outlines, large white spaces, no shading, no colour fill, no text, suitable for children aged [AGE].

Use when: You are a teacher printing a full set for the whole class in one go. If the tool makes only one image at a time, ask for the subjects one by one.

See a finished page - the baby elephant

This sample was made with the Master Prompt above, using the subject "a baby elephant under a tree". Look at what makes it work: one friendly subject, thick lines everywhere, big empty spaces inside the elephant, the leaves and the sun - and no shading, no colour and no words.



A ready-to-print sample page - or make your own with any subject your child asks for.

Printing tips that save paper and ink

- **Print on A4 at 100% size** - choose "Actual size" or "Fit to page", never a small thumbnail.
- **Test one page first** - check the lines are dark and thick before printing a whole class set.
- **Use normal paper for crayons** - slightly thicker paper is better for marker pens, so colours do not bleed through.
- **Save the file** - keep the downloaded image, and you can print the same favourite page again, any time.

Use AI honestly and safely

Keep children safe. An adult should always make and check the page first. Look at the picture yourself before giving it to a child.

Protect privacy. Never upload a child's photo, name or school name to turn into a colouring page. A subject name like "baby elephant" is enough.

Colouring is the learning. The AI only draws the outlines - the child's own colours and patience are the real work.

Try it now - 3 quick tasks

1. Ask your child or class for one favourite animal and run the Master Prompt on it.
2. Make one Learning Page - a big letter or number with a matching object beside it.
3. Print a Class Set of 5 pages on one theme and keep the spare copies for a rainy day.

More free shortcuts in this series: Classroom Poster Image - Science Diagram - Story Starter - Infographic Image.